MIL-A-35040A
31 DECEMBER 1964

SUPERSEDING
MIL-A-35040
21 MAY 1959

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

ALMOND PASTE

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers almond paste for use by the Armed Forces as an item of general issue.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 — Box, Fiberboard.

PPP-C-96 — Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter.

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 — Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items.

MIL-C-10506 — Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 — Marking for Shipment and Storage.

MIL-STD-668 — Minimum Sanitary Standards for Food Establishments.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 **Other publications.** The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, shall apply:

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION, AND WELFARE

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the U. S. Government Printing Office, Division of Public Documents, Washington, D.C., 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE

U.S. Standards for Shelled Almonds.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the U.S. Department of Agriculture, Agricultural Marketing Service, Washington, D.C., 20250.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL AGRICULTURAL CHEMISTS

Official Methods of Analysis.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, D. C., 20044.)

FSC 8925

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample approal. When specified (see 6.1), a sample of the finished product shall be submitted to the contracting officer for approval before production is commenced.

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 *Almonds.* Almonds shall comply with the requirements of U. S. No. 1 grade as defined in U. S. Standards for Shelled Almonds.

3.2.2 *Sugar.* Sugar shall be white, refined cane or beet sugar, or both combined.

* **3.3 Finished product.** The finished product shall consist solely of almonds and sugar, ground and mixed to the extent necessary to produce a smooth homogeneous almond paste. The paste shall contain not less than 25 percent almond fat and not more than 12.5 percent moisture. The paste shall possess a flavor typical of almonds and shall be free from objectional odors and flavors.

3.4 All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

* **3.5 Workmanship.** The product shall be processed with minimum delay between the various stages of production.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* **4.1 Responsibility for inspection.** Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may use his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

** **4.2 Preacceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection).** Inspection of plants producing the product shall be conducted by the Military Veterinary Services. Award of contract shall be limited to establishments which maintain sanitary conditions in accordance with MIL–STD–668 and which have received prior sanitary approval.

\# **4.3 Sampling for inspection.** Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL–STD–105, except as otherwise indicated herein.

\# **4.3.1** *Inspection of components (examination and testing).* Quality assurance provision for components and materials shall be in accordance with 4.3.1.1 and 4.3.1.2 and subsidiary specification to the extent applicable except that this specification shall govern in case of conflict.

\# **4.3.1.1** *Examination of ingredients.* Determination of compliance with 3.2.1 and 3.2.2 as concerns identity shall be ascertained by examination of labels, grade certificates, invoices, or other valid documents. Use of ingredients not conforming to identity requirements shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of finished product made therefrom, as applicable.

\# 4.3.1.2 *Testing of components.* Testing of components described in this specification and changes in the testing of components listed in subsidiary specifications shall be as listed below. Requirements for the test characteristic is applicable to the lot average. Cans shall be considered unacceptable if one or more test results indicate nonconformance to requirement.

Components	*Sample unit*	*Lot size expressed in*	*Inspection level*	*Characteristics*	*Result reported*	*Test ref. & reqmt. para.*
Cans & lids[1]	1 can & lid	Cans	S–3	Tin plate	Nearest 0.01 lb/ base box	5.1.1 4.5.3

[1] Testing of can coating and labeling shall be accomplished on same cans used for testing of tin plate.

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4.3.2 *Examination of end item.* Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with tables I through IV and 4.3.2.1 through 4.3.2.3. The inspection levels, sample units, and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) for the above tables shall be as shown below. Lot sizes shall be expressed in terms of cans. AQLs shall be expressed as defects per hundred units:

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	AQLs			
			Major A	*Major B*	*Minor*	*Total*
I	I	1 filled & sealed can	0.25	1.5	—	4.0
II	S–3	1 filled & sealed can	—	—	2.5	—
III	S–2	Contents of 1 can	—	2.5	—	—
IV	S–3	1 filled & sealed can	—	2.5	—	—

TABLE I. *External examination of primary container* (see 6.2)

Categories			Defect
Major A	*Major B*	*Minor*	
101			Leaker or hole in can.
102			Springer, flipper, or sweller.
103			Not closed, or otherwise improperly closed.
		201	Not clean.[1]
	151		Not type, size or style specified.
	152		Severe dent.
	153		Dent causing sharp ridge.
		202	Moderate dent.
	154		Severe paneling, buckling or collapsed can.
	155		Cable cut.
	156		Pitted rust.[2]
		203	Excessive amount of flux on ends or sides.[3]

[1] Cans showing a very thin film of grease which is discernible to the touch but not readily discernible visually are considered to be clean.
[2] Rust that can be removed by a soft cloth will not be considered as pitted rust.
[3] Traces of flux at edges of soldered areas, normally encountered in can manufacturing but not enough to cause corrosion, will not be considered excessive.

TABLE II. *Examination for net weight*[1]

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Less than 6 pounds, 12 ounces.[2]

[1] Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicates lot average net weight is less than specified net weight.
[2] Report to nearest ¼ ounce.

4.3.2.1 *Examination of can labeling.* Examination of can label shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of MIL–L–1497.

4.3.2.2 *Examination of can coating.* When exterior coating is required to be in accordance with MIL–C–10506, examination shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of that specification.

TABLE III. *Examination of interior can coating and product characteristics*[1]

Category	Defect
Major B	
151	Not a homogeneous paste.
152	Odor and taste not typical of product, i.e., rancid, burnt, musty, bitter, etc.
153	Interior coating missing, incomplete or easily abraded by fingernail (level A only).

[1] Presence of foreign material, i.e., metal, wood, glass, filth, insects, insect fragments, etc., shall be cause for rejection of the entire lot.

TABLE IV. *Examination of vacuum* (see 4.5.2)

Category	Defect
Major B	
151	Vacuum less than 20 inches.

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4.3.2.3 *Examination of shipping containers.* Examination of the filled and sealed shipping container shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of the appendix to PPP–B–636. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the examination: Major: marking missing, incorrect or illegible. Minor: arrangements not as specified. When level C pack is required, the examination criteria of PPP–B–636 shall apply except that only the defects applicable to marking and arrangement shall be pertinent. In addition, for level C pack, shipping containers other than fiberboard shall be unacceptable.

* 4.3.3 *Sampling procedures and acceptance criteria for testing of finished product.* The finished product shall be tested for moisture and fat as specified in 3.3. Procedures for testing shall be in accordance with 4.5. The sample for testing shall be a 1-pound composite derived from the number of primary containers indicated by inspection level S–3. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of primary containers. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 per cent for moisture and nearest 1 percent for fat. The lot shall be rejected if one or both test results indicate nonconformance to requirements.

* 4.4 **Standby test samples.** The Government reserves the right to withdraw and hold standby test samples of components or finished product or both (quantity of which shall be not more than twice that required by this specification) for inspection purposes. Samples not used will be returned to the supplier.

4.5 **Tests.** Test procedures and controls which differ from those specified herein, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government inspection activity determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum, such quality assurance, the supplier will use the test procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to test results, the test methods specified herein will govern.

4.5.1 *Chemical analyses.* Chemical analyses shall be made in accordance with the following methods from Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists:

Test	*Source*	*Method*
Moisture ....Chapter:	Sugar and Sugar Products	Moisture
Section:	Sugars, Sirups, and Molasses	Vacuum drying
Fat .....Chapter:	Nuts and Nut Products	Crude Fat Direct Method

4.5.2 *Can vacuum.* After processing, sample cans shall be selected which are free from dents or other visible damage. The cans and contents shall be allowed to reach a temperature of 75° ± 5° F. the vacuum reading shall then be taken with a puncture-type vacuum gage, making the puncture as near as possible to the double seam to minimize error due to distortion of the end. For normal inspection purposes, a correction of 1 inch of vacuum shall be added to the gage reading for each 1,000 feet above sea level at which the determination is made. The following is an example of a normal inspection vacuum determination:

	Inches
Vacuum reading	6
Altitude correction (2000 ft.)	2
Corrected vacuum	8

If greater accuracy is considered necessary, sample cans shall be submitted to a laboratory for vacuum determination corrected to standard conditions (68° F. and 29.9 inches of mercury). Corrections for gage and headspace errors shall be included.

4.5.3 *Tin coating weights.* Tin coating weights shall be determined by any method described in PPP–C–96.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 **Packaging.** The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1 or 5.1.2, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.* Seven pounds of the product shall be filled into a size 603 by 700 open-top

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style, round metal can with soldered side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. After filling, the can shall be hermetically sealed in such a way that it will have a vacuum of not less than 20 inches when tested in accordance with 4.5.2. The can shall be made throughout from commercial 0.25-pound per base box electrolytic tin place (see 4.5.3). The can shall be coated overall inside with an enamel furnished by the can manufacturer in accordance with best commercial practice for the product, and coated overall outside with a coating conforming to type I or II, or when specified (see 6.1), type III of MIL–C–10506. The can shall be fabricated from metal having a base weight and temper capable of withstanding the required vacuum without paneling.

5.1.2 *Level C.* The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1 except that cans with or without commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. Six cans of the product, arranged 3 in length, 2 in width, and 1 in depth, shall be packed on end in snug-fitting shipping containers in accordance with 5.2.1, 5.2.2, or 5.2.3, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 *Level A.* The container shall be a fiberboard box with sleeve, constructed, closed, and metal strapped in accordance with style RSC–SL, V2s of PPP–B–636.

5.2.2 *Level B.* The container shall be a fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, type CF or SF, class domestic, of PPP–B–636.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.1 and 6.3), the container shall be a fiberboard box, constructed, closed, and strapped in accordance with style RSC, V3s or V3c, of PPP–B–636.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The container shall be a fiberboard box which is acceptable to common carriers for safe transportation to point of destination specified in shipping instructions at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 *Cans.* Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL–L–1497.

5.3.2 *Shipping containers.* Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Whether preproduction sample is to be furnished (see 3.1).

(c) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

(d) When type III exterior can coating is required (see 5.1.1).

(e) When packing specified in 5.2.2.1 is required.

6.2 Can defects. To aid in the classification of can defects, the following documents are suggested as guides.

(a) Visual Inspection Gage Set No. 33A-2D, Standard Classification for Can Defects, 11 Dec. 1960; or

(b) Visual Inspection Aids A1-G2, as specified in AMS Handbook, Exterior Condition of Filled Food Containers, Aug. 8, 1963.

6.3 Packing specified in 5.2.2.1 is intended to provide the limited Military protection required for: shipment of supplies to certain specified overseas destinations; transfer at sea; and for shipment and storage of Special Program Reserves.

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6.4 The outside margins of this document have been marked to indicate where changes from the previous issue have been made. An asterisk (*) indicates a substantive change in the paragraph text. A double asterisk (**) indicates deletion of a paragraph bearing the same number. The number sign (#) indicates the addition of a completely new paragraph. This has been done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content as written irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:
Army—GL
Navy—SA
Air Force—67

Review activities:
Army—MD
Navy—MC, SA
Air Force—67

Preparing activity:
Army—GL

Project No. 8925–0028

Note. Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current Federal Supply Classification Listing Of DOD Documents.

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"to detach this form, cut along this line"

SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity.

SPECIFICATION: Almond Paste - MIL-A-35040A

ORGANIZATION	CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.	QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED	DOLLAR AMOUNT
		$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*	DATE

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